

SD Versus DDR

Q I have a Celeron 1.7 GHz processor, a VIA motherboard and 128 MB SD RAM. I want to upgrade my RAM and have four slots on my motherboard—two DDR and two SD slots. Will I be able to use DDR and SD memory simultaneously, and just add 128 MB DDR RAM to my computer?

Gagan Cheema

A Unfortunately, you cannot. You can choose to run your system either on DDR or SD RAM, but the two will not run simultaneously. We suggest you sell the SD RAM to your vendor, and buy 256 MB of DDR memory. As of now, SD RAM costs more than DDR RAM, because the former has been discontinued.

The Death Of A CD-ROM

Q I have a Celeron 266 MHz processor with a 20 GB hard drive and 64 MB RAM. I bought a Samsung 52X CD-ROM about two years ago. Last month it suddenly started acting up and refused to detect re-writable CDs. After many tries, it detected the CD-RW as an audio CD, and now treats all CD-RWs as audio CDs. What's wrong?

Rakshit Desai

A Your CD-ROM drive is on its last legs. You can try a lens cleaner to make sure this isn't caused by a dirty lens. If the lens cleaner doesn't solve the problem, you will have to buy a new drive.

Beat The Heat

Q I have a Pentium III 1.0 GHz, a Mercury 815e motherboard, an 80 GB hard drive and 150 MB of SD RAM. The problem is that my heat sink gets really hot, and as a result, the PC hangs or restarts. The CPU fan is working fine, but the BIOS setting doesn't show its RPM. I have another case fan, and the BIOS reports its speed. Is there a problem with my motherboard?

Abhay

A In order to find the culprit, you need to make sure that the CPU fan is working correctly. Open your cabinet and make sure the fan rotates easily. Make sure the heat sink and fan blades are free from dust.

You can use a paint brush to clean both. If necessary, remove the fan and heat sink, clean them thoroughly, and apply thermal paste again and fix them back on to the CPU.

To make sure that it's a heating problem, you can try running the CPU with the same heat sink and fan on another motherboard.

Another factor, due to which the BIOS may not be reporting the RPM speed of the CPU fan correctly, could be that the CPU fan cable is not connected to the proper connector on the motherboard. You may want to check that.

If all is in order and you still have an issue,

you will have to opt for an external CPU fan kit which will lighten your wallet by Rs 600.

We Have A Spy In Our Midst

Q Whenever I log onto the Internet, my computer gets infected with viruses. I use AVG as my anti-virus, but it seems to be of no use. I run Windows XP with Service Pack 1. My virus definitions are always up-to-date. While scanning my computer with spybot, it says, "There is a security hole in your computer which allows unauthorised material to pass on to your computer without your knowledge." What do I do?

Akash

A Your problem stems from a Trojan or spyware that has been installed. What you can do is run SpyBot and make it remove the spyware. Download and install the latest Windows and anti-virus updates. This will ensure that your computer stays safe all the time. Also turn on the inbuilt Windows Firewall. Turn to Page 56 for more instructions on securing your Windows XP PC in 30 minutes.



Illustrations: Mahesh Benkar

Carbon Copies

Q I brought my friend's hard drive over to copy some data to my system. After I was done, that hard disk developed problems. My friend says some system files are missing. I formatted the hard drive, and now want to copy all the software that is on my drive to his. I do not have any software CDs though. Is there a way to copy everything, as it is on my drive, to his drive—including the OS?

Shaik Basha



Norton Ghost creates an exact copy of your hard drive

A It's possible, but it won't work because your friend will have a different hardware configuration. If by some miracle, you both have exactly, and we mean EXACTLY the same configuration, you can use utilities such as Norton Ghost or DriveImage to make an image file (exact copy) of your hard drive on to your friends. ■